8 Automating acceptance criteria for the UI layer

This chapter covers

- Why and when you should write automated UI tests
- Using Selenium WebDriver for web tests
- Finding and interacting with page elements in your tests
- Using the Page Objects pattern to make your tests cleaner
- Libraries that extend Selenium WebDriver

In the previous chapter, you learned how using a layered approach to automated acceptance testing helps make your tests clearer, more robust, and more maintainable. We discussed the three broad layers used in well-designed automated acceptance tests: the *Business Rules* layer, the *Business Flow* layer, and the *Technical* layer. In the following few chapters, we'll focus on approaches and tools that can be used to implement the Technical layer, starting with the user interface.

In this chapter we'll discuss techniques to automate UI tests for web-based applications (see figure 8.1). Users interact with an application through its user interface, and in modern web applications, the UI implementation plays a major role in